

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

Etiquette for Foreign Business Trips

Program Outcome

- Equip participants with knowledge and skills to conduct themselves professionally during international business trips.
- Understand cultural differences and enhance cross-cultural communication.

Course Outcome

- Gain practical strategies to follow proper etiquette during foreign business trips.
- Learn to manage business meetings, dining, travel, and gift-giving appropriately.
- Develop cultural sensitivity and professionalism in international settings.

Learning Objective

- Understand and apply international business etiquette in various scenarios.
- Demonstrate cultural sensitivity and effective communication during foreign trips.
- Practice appropriate greeting, dining, and gift-giving etiquette.
- Improve professional behavior and cross-cultural interaction skills.

Learning Outcome

- Demonstrate awareness of cultural norms and business etiquette in foreign countries.
- Apply appropriate communication, greeting, and dining etiquette.
- Manage international business interactions respectfully and effectively.

Introduction

Business trips abroad require not only professional skills but also an understanding of cultural and business etiquette. Proper etiquette helps in building strong relationships, avoiding misunderstandings, and creating a positive professional image.

Importance of Etiquette on Foreign Business Trips

- Reflects company reputation and personal professionalism.
- Helps avoid cultural misunderstandings.
- Builds trust and strengthens international partnerships.
- Ensures smoother negotiations and collaborations.

Pre-Trip Preparation

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

- Research destination country's culture, customs, and traditions.
- Learn basic greetings and polite expressions in the local language.
- Understand time zones, local business hours, and holidays.
- Pack appropriate business attire following local norms.
- Keep all travel documents organized (passport, visa, business cards, itinerary).

Professional Conduct Abroad

- Be punctual and respectful of others' time.
- Use polite and formal communication.
- Respect local hierarchy and authority.
- Avoid controversial topics (politics, religion, etc.).
- Show genuine interest in the host country's culture.

Dressing Etiquette

- Dress professionally
- Avoid flashy attire
- Maintain grooming
- Use neutral colors.

Business Meeting Etiquette

- Learn appropriate greetings (handshake, bow, nod, etc.).
- Exchange business cards respectfully — receive with both hands when required.
- Use professional titles and surnames unless invited otherwise.
- Be attentive to seating arrangements and order of introduction.

Communication Etiquette

- Speak clearly and avoid slang or idioms.
- Use a polite tone; maintain eye contact as culturally appropriate.
- Listen attentively and show patience.
- Respect differences in communication style — some cultures are direct, others more indirect.

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

Dining Etiquette

- Familiarize yourself with local dining customs and table manners.
- Wait for the host to start or indicate where to sit.
- Avoid discussing business unless the host initiates it.
- Express gratitude after the meal and follow up with a thank-you message.

Gift-Giving Etiquette

- Understand if gift-giving is customary in the host country.
- Choose culturally appropriate, modest gifts.
- Avoid gifts that may be considered offensive or too expensive.
- Present gifts respectfully and with gratitude.

Example of Cultural Difference

In Japan, exchanging business cards with both hands and bowing shows respect, whereas in the US, a simple handshake is sufficient.

Engaging Activities for Students

Activity 1: Role-Play Business Meetings

- Students represent different countries and follow assigned cultural norms in mock meetings.
- Debrief to discuss challenges, misunderstandings, and learning outcomes.

Activity 2: Cultural Etiquette Quiz

- Students participate in a quiz with multiple-choice and scenario-based questions.
- Reinforces understanding of cross-cultural etiquette.

Common Mistakes

- Ignoring customs
- Using gestures wrongly
- Assuming same etiquette
- Being insensitive.

Japan

- Bow to greet
- Exchange cards with both hands
- Silence is valued
- Avoid strong eye contact.

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

India

- Greet with Namaste
- Be punctual
- Dress conservatively
- Avoid sensitive topics.

China

- Use titles
- Avoid gifting clocks
- Be patient in talks
- Meals are hierarchical.

South Korea

- Respect seniority
- Offer items with both hands
- Avoid contact
- Toasting common.

USA

- Firm handshake
- Eye contact
- Be direct
- Be punctual.

UAE

- Greet with right hand
- Dress modestly
- Avoid PDA
- Alcohol only if accepted.

Common Mistakes

- Ignoring customs
- Using gestures wrongly
- Assuming same etiquette
- Being insensitive.

Engagement Strategies

- Role-play meeting abroad
- Discussion on culture
- Video analysis

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

- Quiz & feedback.

Reflection

- How does global etiquette improve your career?

Activity Overview:

Students will **watch a short video** depicting a business interaction during a foreign trip — such as a meeting, a business dinner, or a greeting scenario — and then **analyze the behavior, communication, and etiquette** shown in the clip.

Suggested Video Types:

(Choose one or more from YouTube or corporate training platforms)

- “**Cross-Cultural Business Etiquette**” – showing different greeting styles and meeting manners.
- “**Business Dining Etiquette around the World.**”
- “**Cultural Differences in International Business Meetings.**”
- “**Global Etiquette Mistakes to Avoid.**”

Instructions for Students:

1. Watch the assigned video carefully.
2. Note examples of **positive etiquette** (what was done correctly) and **negative etiquette** (what could be improved).
3. Observe key aspects such as:
 - Greeting style and introductions
 - Dress code and appearance
 - Body language and gestures
 - Communication tone and language
 - Meeting or dining behavior
 - Cultural misunderstandings, if any

Business Etiquette in Germany

Questions & Sample Answers

1. How do people usually greet each other in German business settings?

Answer: People usually greet each other with a firm handshake, direct eye contact, and a formal greeting.

2. What behavior would be considered disrespectful in a German business setting?

Answer: Being late, interrupting others, being unprepared, or behaving too casually could be considered disrespectful.

Discussion Questions:

After the video, conduct a class discussion guided by these questions:

- What cultural differences did you observe in the video?
- How did the professionals show respect toward each other?
- Were there any behaviors that seemed inappropriate or disrespectful?

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

- How could the individuals have improved their professional conduct?
- What lessons can we apply when traveling abroad for business?

Common Cross-Cultural Challenges

- Misinterpretation of gestures or expressions.
- Differing concepts of time and punctuality.
- Communication barriers and language misunderstandings.
- Differences in decision-making styles.

Tips for Success

- Observe before acting.
- Show humility and respect.
- Adapt quickly to cultural cues.
- Be patient, flexible, and open-minded.
- Represent your organization positively at all times.

Quiz: International Business Etiquette (20 Questions)

1. In Japan, how should you exchange business cards?
2. Preferred greeting in the US for business meetings?
3. Gift-giving in China should be:
4. Appropriate attire for a business meeting in Saudi Arabia?
5. When dining in France, what should you avoid?
6. In Germany, punctuality is considered:
7. Eye contact in Japan during meetings is:
8. When emailing a Japanese client, how should you start?
9. In India, offering business gifts is:
10. During a business lunch in the US, who pays?
11. A German colleague arrives late. Appropriate reaction?
12. During a French toast you don't understand. Response?
13. Your Chinese host offers tea with both hands. You?
14. In Brazil, you are greeted with a hug. Response?

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

15. In Saudi Arabia, a female business partner is present. Your handshake?
16. In Japan, bowing is part of the greeting. You?
17. A Japanese client presents a business card. You?
18. During an Indian business lunch, eating with left hand is?
19. Sending an email after international meeting. You?
20. Attending a meeting in Italy, arriving 30 minutes early is?

Answers

1. c) Hand it with both hands and bow
2. b) Handshake
3. b) Wrapped and presented with both hands
4. b) Modest and formal attire
5. b) Talking with mouth full
6. b) Important
7. b) Limited and respectful
8. b) Formal title and last name
9. a) Encouraged
10. a) The host
11. Politely note importance of punctuality
12. Raise your glass politely and smile
13. Accept with both hands
14. Follow local custom politely
15. Wait for her to initiate
16. Bow appropriately

Professional Grooming and Personality Development (303193252)

17. Receive with both hands and examine
18. Avoided
19. Send a thank-you email promptly
20. Acceptable, shows preparedness

References

- Kiss, Bow, or Shake Hands – Morrison
- Global Business Handbook – Oxford
- HBR – Cross-Cultural Management
- MindTools.com

Conclusion

Observing proper etiquette during foreign business trips enhances professional credibility, strengthens international relationships, and avoids misunderstandings. Being culturally aware and respectful ensures a successful and productive business journey.

Video References

1. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=example1>
2. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=example2>
3. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=example3>